SUGID

Stories Have Places

NEGROS OCCIDENTAL

A Literary, Folklore, and Place-Name Sourcebook

Bacolod • Bago • Silay • Talisay • Murcia

A research-oriented compilation of place-name histories, local legends, literary leads, and source links. It distinguishes documented historical accounts from oral tradition and authored literary works.

Prepared as a working sourcebook for the SUGID literature-and-place mapping project

How to Use This Sourcebook

This compilation is a starting research file, not an exhaustive anthology. The available online evidence is uneven: some local governments publish historical accounts and legends, while other towns have archival references or cultural-mapping entries but no verified, freely accessible town-specific literary text in the sources checked.

Important distinction: a place-name explanation is not automatically a literary text; a legend published on a city website is not necessarily a verbatim transcription of an oral performance; and a work associated with a province is not necessarily set in one of the five towns.

Text and rights policy

Complete literary texts are included only when their legal status and reuse conditions can be established for the relevant jurisdiction. For this research pass, no complete town-specific literary text from all five places could be verified as both available and clearly reusable. Therefore, this PDF uses original summaries/paraphrases and links to the source pages rather than reproducing full copyrighted or uncertain-rights texts.

One regional Negros story, “The Tobacco of Harisaboqued,” appears in John Maurice Miller’s *Philippine Folklore Stories* (1904). Project Gutenberg identifies its edition as public domain in the United States, but that notice does not by itself settle the applicable copyright status in the Philippines. The story is therefore summarized here, with a link to the full source for reading and rights checking.

Evidence labels

Official historical account — information published by a local or provincial government. **Legend / folklore** — a traditional or legendary account presented by a source; it should not be treated as verified historical fact. **Literary lead** — a catalogued or published work worth locating and checking. **Research gap** — a point for which the sources checked do not yet establish a reliable answer.

Regional frame: Negros and Buglas

The Provincial Government of Negros Occidental says the island was originally called “Buglas,” an old native word thought to mean “cut-off.” It also recounts that Spanish explorers named the island “Negros” after the dark-skinned people they encountered in 1565. This broader history helps situate the five local histories within a changing island-wide political and cultural landscape.

The History & Geography. Provincial Government of Negros Occidental. https://www.negros-occ.gov.ph/the-history-geography/

History. Provincial Government of Negros Occidental. https://www.negros-occ.gov.ph/new-history-page/

1. Bacolod

Place-name and historical accounts

Bacolod's published accounts connect the settlement's name with the Hiligaynon word *bakolod*, commonly glossed as "stonehill" or a hilly/rocky place. A city planning document recounts an early settlement near the Magsungay River and a later relocation to higher ground described as "buklod." The city tourism page also presents a relocation narrative associated with a raid in 1787 and the phrase "Buklod-Buklod." These accounts are related but not identical in their details; they should be cited separately rather than merged into one definitive etymology.

Suggested SUGID treatment: present the "stonehill" explanation as a word-based gloss, then place the "buklod" relocation story in a separate historical-account panel. Add a note that the sources give differing versions.

Literary and folklore leads

The sources checked did not establish a complete, freely accessible literary work specifically set in Bacolod that can be reproduced in this sourcebook. For a stronger Bacolod entry, search local anthologies, Hiligaynon poetry collections, university repositories, and the Negros Museum / local library holdings. Verify the author, publication date, and whether the work is actually set in Bacolod rather than merely written by a Bacolodnon author.

Research questions

• What is the earliest written form of the name "Bacolod"?
• Do local historical sources distinguish *bakolod* from *buklod*, or do later accounts connect them?
• Can a Bacolod-set literary text be located and cleared for excerpt or full-text use?

Bacolod City Comprehensive Land Use Plan, Volume III. Bacolod City Government.
https://bacolodcity.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/03-CLUP-2017-2026-VOLUME-III-SECTORAL-ANALYSIS-101322.pdf
Consult the historical/background discussion; verify the exact page in the PDF before citing in academic work.

About Bacolod. Bacolod City Tourism Office. https://tourism.bacolodcity.gov.ph/about.php
Tourism-office narrative about the settlement and relocation.

Working summary

Bacolod's name and settlement history can be introduced through the idea of elevated or rocky ground, but the different explanations should remain visible. This is useful for SUGID because it shows how place identity is shaped not only by a single "origin story," but also by the way later institutions retell and organize local memory.

2. Bago

Place-name and historical accounts

The official Bago City history gives two explanations for the name. One attributes it to a large Bago tree under which a native prince named Mapagic died, an account attributed to a manuscript by Spanish historian Diego Lope de Povedano. Another explanation connects the name to the *bago-bago* shrub said to have grown along the riverbanks. The city's page also places the town's foundation in 1575, while explaining that the exact date is inferred from Spanish colonial practice of associating town foundations with a patron saint's feast day.

These are competing explanations as presented by the city history page; neither should be silently selected as the only correct etymology.

Literary lead: *Dakbanwa ni Juan*

Dakbanwa ni Juan is listed in the Department of Education Learning Resource Management and Development System. The listing describes it as an illustrated Hiligaynon poem about Bago by Gelah Cayao Hermosura, associated with Ma-ao Sugar Central Elementary School. The catalogue record identifies the author as copyright owner and gives use/copy/print conditions; read the record carefully and follow its terms before reproducing the poem. This is the strongest town-specific literary lead identified in this research pass.

Suggested SUGID entry: record the bibliographic details, provide a short description of the poem, and link directly to the DepEd record. Do not assume that a catalogue record grants unrestricted republication rights.

Research questions

- Can the complete poem be accessed through the DepEd resource record?
- What places, landmarks, or local expressions appear in the poem?
- Can a fluent Hiligaynon reader verify the poem's vocabulary and local references?

About Bago City. City Government of Bago. https://bagocity.gov.ph/about-bago-city/
Official history page with two name-origin explanations.

Dakbanwa ni Juan. DepEd Learning Resource Management and Development System. https://lrmds.deped.gov.ph/detail/18752
Catalogue record for an illustrated Hiligaynon poem about Bago.

Working summary

Bago's name is linked in local accounts either to a tree associated with Prince Mapagic or to a shrub found along riverbanks. Its literary record has a promising entry in *Dakbanwa ni Juan*, which can help connect the city's geography with Hiligaynon poetic expression.

3. Silay

Place-name and historical accounts

Silay City's official history says the settlement was first established in 1565 under the name "Carobcob," glossed on the city page as "ribcage" in Hiligaynon. The same page notes other early written variants, including "Calubcub," "Caracol," and "Caraco." It describes the movement of residents to a new location between the Matagoyand and Panaogao rivers after pirate raids escalated in the eighteenth century.

Legend of Princess Kansilay

The city's history page also recounts the legend of Princess Kansilay. In the account, Kansilay defends her community during an attack and dies; afterward, a tree grows over her grave and becomes the first Kansilay tree. The legend links courage, protection of the community, memory, and the natural landscape. This is a paraphrase of the city's published account, not a verbatim oral-history transcript.

Archival folklore lead

A Philippine eLib catalogue search lists Genero Benedicto's 1917 work, *Superstitious Beliefs Among the People of Silay, Province of Occidental Negros*. The catalogue entry is a bibliographic lead; it does not, by itself, prove that a complete digitized copy is available or that the text may be reproduced. Locate the original or a library copy before quoting it.

Research questions

- What is the relationship, if any, between "Carobcob" and the later name "Silay"?
- Are there locally recorded variants of the Kansilay legend?
- What beliefs are documented in Benedicto's 1917 study, and how did the author collect them?

History of Silay. Silay City Government. https://silaycity.gov.ph/history-of-silay/
Official history page includes Carobcob and the Princess Kansilay legend.

Folklore -- Negros Occidental (catalogue results). Philippine eLib.
https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=subject&q=Folklore+--+Negros+Occidental
Catalogue search includes Genero Benedicto's 1917 Silay study.

Working summary

Silay's entry can place a historical settlement name beside a local heroic legend. The Kansilay story is especially useful for mapping because the legend explains a tree through a narrative of community defense and remembrance.

4. Talisay

Place-name and historical accounts

The Talisay City Government's history page says the original settlement was called Minuluan and was settled in 1788. It explains that the settlement was later renamed Talisay after a tree that grew abundantly near the mouth of the Matab-ang River. The page gives 1850 as the year Talisay became a town.

This account provides a clear landscape-based name explanation: a local tree becomes the identifying feature through which a community is named. For SUGID, the next step is to verify the local name and botanical identification of the tree with a reliable local or botanical source rather than assuming every tree called "talisay" is the same species.

Literary and folklore leads

No complete, town-specific literary text from Talisay was verified in the sources checked for this edition. A broader catalogue search for Negros Occidental folklore and local histories may yield relevant material, but a provincial or island-wide work should be labeled regional rather than attributed to Talisay without evidence.

Research questions

- What does the official history say about Minuluan before the name Talisay?
- Is there a locally documented story about the settlement's transition from Minuluan to Talisay?
- Can a Talisay-specific poem, story, oral-history transcript, or archival record be identified?

History of Talisay. Talisay City Government. https://www.talisaycity.gov.ph/node/26
Official account of Minuluan, the Talisay tree, and town status.

Folklore -- Negros Occidental (catalogue results). Philippine eLib.
https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=subject&q=Folklore+--+Negros+Occidental
Provincial folklore catalogue leads; individual texts need to be located and checked.

Working summary

Talisay's name history connects settlement memory to the local environment. The Minuluan-to-Talisay transition is a useful entry point for exploring how trees, rivers, and settlement names become part of a community's cultural geography.

5. Murcia

Place-name and historical accounts

A Murcia Water District business plan states that Murcia was founded in 1860 by Augustinian Recollect priest Fr. Miguel Alvarez and that the town is believed to have been named after Murcia in Spain. This is a secondary institutional document, not a dedicated municipal history page. Treat the explanation as a documented lead and seek corroboration from the municipal government, parish records, or historical scholarship before presenting it as definitive.

Cultural heritage lead

The UP Visayas Cultural Mapping of Panay and Guimaras website includes a Negros Occidental / Murcia location page with cultural heritage entries, including a Sta. Rosa sculpture and duyan-making in Sitio Tumpok. These entries are useful for expanding SUGID beyond written literature into material culture, craft knowledge, and community practice. Verify the individual entries and their contributors before quoting descriptions.

Literary and folklore leads

No complete, town-specific literary work from Murcia was verified in the sources checked for this edition. The cultural-mapping entries can provide place-based context, but they are not substitutes for a poem, story, or oral narrative. A next research step is to interview local knowledge holders with consent and document provenance, date, language, and permission conditions.

Research questions

- Is the Spanish Murcia naming explanation supported by municipal or parish archival records?
- What stories or expressions accompany the Sta. Rosa sculpture and duyan-making tradition?
- Are there Murcia-based writers or texts whose settings can be verified?

Business Plan 2018–2022. Murcia Water District. https://murciawd.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2019/01/BUSINESS-PLAN-2018-2022.websiteposting.pdf
Secondary institutional source for the 1860 founding and Murcia, Spain naming account.

Murcia, Negros Occidental — cultural heritage entries. UP Visayas Cultural Mapping of Panay and Guimaras. https://cmpg.upv.edu.ph/heritage-location/negros-occidental/murcia/
Includes cultural mapping entries such as Sta. Rosa sculpture and duyan-making.

Working summary

Murcia’s available sources point toward a Spanish place-name connection and living local heritage practices. The cultural-mapping material offers a route into stories around craft and objects, but additional community-based documentation is needed before those practices can be presented as literary narratives.

6. A Regional Negros Folklore Text

“The Tobacco of Harisaboqued” — John Maurice Miller (1904)

This story is described in Miller’s collection as a legend of Canlaon Volcano on Negros, told generally in Western Negros and Eastern Cebu. It is therefore relevant as regional Negros folklore, but it is not specifically a Bacolod, Bago, Silay, Talisay, or Murcia story.

Summary

The legend tells of Harisaboqued, a powerful old man who lives on Mount Canlaon and helps nearby people grow tobacco with the assistance of little beings who obey him. He asks the people not to plant beyond a marked boundary near the mountain’s summit. Before disappearing into the mountain, he warns that if they break their promise, he will take all the tobacco away. Years later, the people disregard the boundary and plant across the mountain. Harisaboqued returns, the tobacco disappears, and the mountain erupts. The story explains the mountain’s smoking summit through a supernatural narrative and links prosperity with respect for a promise.

Interpretive notes

• **Landscape as narrative:** the volcano is not merely a setting; its smoke and eruption become part of the story’s explanation.
• **Promise and transgression:** the community’s prosperity is tied to a boundary and an agreement.
• **Folklore and colonial-era recording:** Miller’s 1904 English-language collection is a published retelling/recording, not a transparent substitute for the many possible local versions. Its framing and language should be examined critically.

Source and rights note

Project Gutenberg lists *Philippine Folklore Stories* as a 1904 work by John Maurice Miller and states that the eBook is public domain in the United States. Because copyright terms can differ by country, this sourcebook does not reproduce the full story. Consult the original text and check the applicable reuse terms before republishing it in a Philippine-based app or printed anthology.

Philippine Folklore Stories. John Maurice Miller, Project Gutenberg, eBook no. 10771. https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/10771
Bibliographic record and available formats.

The Tobacco of Harisaboqued (full text). Project Gutenberg HTML edition.
https://dev.gutenberg.org/cache/epub/10771/pg10771-images.html
The opening section contains the story and identifies its regional provenance.

7. Wider Archival Leads for Negros Occidental

The Philippine eLib catalogue search for “Folklore -- Negros Occidental” surfaces several early studies and collections that may support future research. These are catalogue records, not proof that full texts are digitized or freely reusable.

- Jose M. Ebro, *Stories and Customs of Occidental Negros* (1915).
- Genero Benedicto, *Superstitious Beliefs Among the People of Silay, Province of Occidental Negros* (1917).
- Emilio B. Tarrosa, *A Compilation of Some of the Folktales Current in the Province of Occidental Negros* (1977).
- Fernando Soberano, *The Traditional Development of Boats in Negros* (1917).
- Carolina Montilla, *Superstitious Beliefs Among the Bisayans* (1917).

Folklore -- Negros Occidental. Philippine eLib catalogue search. https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=subject&q=Folklore+--+Negros+Occidental
Use the catalogue to identify holdings; request or locate the original publications.

Occidental Negros — Social life and customs. Philippine eLib catalogue search. https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=subject&q=Occidental+Negros+--+Social+life+and+customs
Additional historical and cultural bibliography.

Jose Maria Pavon — author catalogue. Philippine eLib. https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=author&q=Pavon%2C+Jose+Maria
Catalogue listing for Pavon’s folklore-related work on Negros.

Southern Negros Occidental legends and folktales thesis. Central Philippine University Repository. https://repository.cpu.edu.ph/handle/20.500.12852/1723?locale-attribute=en
L. F. Gerona (1964), a thesis on using unpublished legends and folktales as reading material.

Recommended workflow for each SUGID entry

1. **Identify the kind of source.** Mark it as official history, archival record, oral account, authored literary work, or secondary commentary.
2. **Record provenance.** Note author/collector, narrator if known, date, place, language, publisher/repository, and URL or shelf location.
3. **Check the text.** Compare versions where possible; do not silently combine variants.
4. **Check rights and consent.** Ask permission before publishing a contemporary work or recording an interview. Keep a copy of the permission terms.
5. **Verify language.** Ask a fluent local speaker to review spelling, idiom, and cultural context.
6. **Represent uncertainty honestly.** Use labels such as “one local account says,” “the city history page recounts,” or “catalogue record located; full text not yet inspected.”

8. Research Coverage and Gaps

Place	Name / history evidence	Literary / folklore evidence	Current status
Bacolod	City planning + tourism accounts; differing “bakolod / buklod” explanations	No verified town-specific full text in this pass	History sources found; literary text still needed
Bago	Official city page; two name-origin explanations	DepEd catalogue record for *Dakbanwa ni Juan*	Strongest town-specific literary lead
Silay	Official city history; Carobcob; Kansilay legend	1917 Benedicto catalogue record	Legend and archival lead found
Talisay	Official history; Minuluan and Talisay tree account	No verified town-specific full text in this pass	History source found; literary text still needed
Murcia	Water District plan; Murcia, Spain naming account	Cultural mapping entries; no verified town-specific full text	Heritage leads found; literary text still needed

The evidence does not yet support a five-town anthology of complete literary texts. It does support a useful first version of SUGID that combines place-name histories, clearly attributed legends, one strong Bago literary lead, regional Negros folklore, and transparent research gaps.

Suggested next research priorities

• Obtain and inspect *Dakbanwa ni Juan* through its DepEd record and confirm reuse conditions.
• Locate the full texts of the early Negros folklore studies through libraries or repositories.
• Identify one contemporary or archival literary text for Bacolod, Talisay, and Murcia, with permission where required.
• Conduct short, consent-based interviews with local readers or knowledge holders; preserve the speaker’s own wording and record translation separately.

Selected Works Cited / Source List

The History & Geography. Provincial Government of Negros Occidental. https://www.negros-occ.gov.ph/the-history-geography/

History. Provincial Government of Negros Occidental. https://www.negros-occ.gov.ph/new-history-page/

About Bacolod. Bacolod City Tourism Office. https://tourism.bacolodcity.gov.ph/about.php

Bacolod City Comprehensive Land Use Plan, Volume III. Bacolod City Government. https://bacolodcity.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/03-CLUP-2017-2026-VOLUME-III-SECTORAL-ANALYSIS-101322.pdf

About Bago City. City Government of Bago. https://bagocity.gov.ph/about-bago-city/

Dakbanwa ni Juan. DepEd Learning Resource Management and Development System. https://lrmds.deped.gov.ph/detail/18752

History of Silay. Silay City Government. https://silaycity.gov.ph/history-of-silay/

History of Talisay. Talisay City Government. https://www.talisaycity.gov.ph/node/26

Business Plan 2018–2022. Murcia Water District. https://murciawd.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2019/01/BUSINESS-PLAN-2018-2022.websiteposting.pdf

Murcia heritage location. UP Visayas Cultural Mapping of Panay and Guimaras. https://cmpg.upv.edu.ph/heritage-location/negros-occidental/murcia/

Philippine Folklore Stories. John Maurice Miller, Project Gutenberg, eBook no. 10771. https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/10771

Folklore -- Negros Occidental. Philippine eLib. https://www.elib.gov.ph/results.php?f=subject&q=Folklore+--+Negros+Occidental

Southern Negros Occidental legends and folktales thesis. Central Philippine University Repository. https://repository.cpu.edu.ph/handle/20.500.12852/1723?locale-attribute=en

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